



BIO 004 · SOLANO COMMUNITY COLLEGE · FALL 2026

Human Anatomy.

Course Syllabus · Tue / Thu · Morning · CRN 80654

5.0 units · 17 weeks · August 17 to December 18, 2026

Vacaville Center · Lecture VC 212 · Lab VC 1137

C-ID BIOL 110B · Cal-GETC Area 5B with laboratory · Transferable to CSU and UC

Read this first How the course runs, what is graded, and every date you need

Keep it It is the agreement between us for the whole term

Also in Canvas The Competency Packet, listing everything this course asks you to be able to do, and the Course Policies and Articulation Reference for the full text of college policy

Contents

Everything you are accountable for this term. Read it once now, and come back to it whenever you need to check something.

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BIO 004 Human Anatomy

Solano Community College · Fall 2026 · Tue / Thu · Morning · CRN 80654 · 5.0 units · Dr. Sharilyn Rennie

01 Course identification and catalog data

CATALOG AND SECTION DATA

Course	BIO 004, Human Anatomy
Units	5.0 semester units
Section	Tue / Thu · Morning
CRN	80654
Term	Fall 2026, full term, 17 weeks. Instruction begins August 17, 2026. Term ends December 18, 2026.
First class meeting	Tuesday, August 18, 2026
Meeting days	Tuesdays and Thursdays. Lecture and lab meet on the same day and both are required.
Lecture	9:30 to 10:45 am, room VC 212, Vacaville Center
Laboratory	11:00 am to 1:50 pm, room VC 1137, Vacaville Center
Format	In person. This is a face-to-face course. It is not online, hybrid, or web-enhanced in the sense of reduced seat time.
Lecture instruction	Scheduled, in person, faculty-led guided lecture instruction on both meeting days, for the full published lecture hours. Every lecture session is taught live by the instructor of record in the assigned classroom. Concept lecture videos are assigned in addition, as preparation, and they do not replace, shorten or substitute for any scheduled in-person lecture session. Attendance at lecture is required.
Laboratory instruction	Scheduled, in person, faculty-supervised laboratory on both meeting days, in the assigned anatomy laboratory. Includes prepared slides, models, and cadaveric human dissections and prosections.
Instructor	Dr. Sharilyn Rennie, Professor of Biology
Level	Majors-level human anatomy. Transfer-level laboratory science, taken by students heading into nursing, allied health, kinesiology and the biological sciences.
Prerequisite and advisory	As published in the current Solano Community College catalog and the approved Course Outline of Record for BIO 004.
Grading	Letter grade. Pass / No Pass may be petitioned through Admissions and Records by the published deadline.

02 Instructor and contact

Instructor	Dr. Sharilyn Rennie, Professor of Biology, Solano Community College
Email	srennie@solano.edu
Best channel	Canvas Inbox. It keeps every course message in one place, which means I can find your history when you need me to.
Reply time	48 to 72 hours on weekdays. Please do not expect a same-day reply the night before a deadline.
Virtual office	The Virtual Office discussion board in Canvas. If you have a question, a classmate almost certainly has the same one.
Office hours	The 30 minutes before each class, in our own room, and by appointment otherwise. If that window never works with your schedule, message me and we will find another time.

Anatomy builds on itself, so a small gap in September is a large one by October. Come and talk to me before you fall behind rather than after. That conversation is much easier for both of us while the gap is still small.

03 Course description and student learning outcomes

Catalog description

BIO 004 is a study of the structural organization of the human body, from the cellular to the organismal level. The course uses three modes of investigation: microscopic study of prepared slides of tissues and organs, gross or macroscopic anatomical study, and examination of prosected human material.

This is a pure anatomy course. We are after structure: what a thing is, where it sits, what it looks like, and how it relates to everything packed in around it. Where function is named, it is named because it explains a structure, and it is labelled as a physiology note when it appears. What runs through all of it is clinical context, because a structure you have seen matter to a real patient is a structure you remember.

Student learning outcomes

By the end of this course you should be able to:

1. Identify and distinguish tissues using currently recognized criteria.
2. Describe the microscopic and gross anatomy of the major systems of the human body.
3. Identify, in the laboratory, the major microscopic and gross structures of those systems.

These three outcomes are the official ones. Everything in Appendix A sits underneath them, and every exam question in this course traces back to one of the three.

04 How this course works

This is an in-person course, and every lecture session is taught live in our own room. On top of that you have the concept lecture video and a guided worksheet to work through on your own time before you come in. The videos are preparation, they are not a replacement for class, and nothing is shortened or moved online because they exist.

What a class day looks like

- **Most days are guided lecture.** We work through the concepts that carry the most weight rather than every detail in the chapter, and you fill in your worksheet as we go. I drop check-in questions into the lecture to see where everyone is, and the students who prepared the night before are the ones who do well on them. The full detail lives in the online lecture and in your worksheet, which is why the pre-work matters.
- **Some days are active learning.** Instead of lecture we run activities and games that make the anatomy stick.
- **Nine days are Team-Based Learning.** Several times across the term you sit a TBL session covering that module's material.
- **Lab runs on most class days.** The online lecture and the worksheet are your preparation. Look them over the night before and lab makes far more sense.
- **You keep one team all term.** Five to seven people, balanced from a Week 1 survey. You take the tRAT together and are graded on it together, and you work the application problems and cases together. Exchange contact details on day one, pick one platform, and answer each other within 24 hours. If your team genuinely is not working, tell me early through the Canvas Inbox, before it festers.

This is a flipped classroom

The name for this design is the flipped classroom. Your first meeting with a concept happens on your own time, in the online lecture video and the guided worksheet. The harder work, applying it, arguing about it, finding the structure with your hands, happens here in the room, where I am standing next to you and your team is at the table with you. It reverses the more familiar order, where the first exposure happens in class and the difficult part gets taken home.

The hard minutes in anatomy are not the ones where you first hear that the sphenoid has a greater wing. They are the ones where you have to find it on a skull with four other bones crowded around it and no labels. Those minutes are worth far more with help in the room, so that is where I put them. The trade is that this front-loads work onto you. The preparation is not optional reading, it is the lecture, and there is no in-class delivery to fall back on if you skip it.

The two kinds of video, and they are not the same thing

- **Lecture videos are the concept lectures.** This is where the content is taught, and this is what the pre-work worksheet is worked against. They carry the detail we will not spend all of class re-delivering.
- **Loops videos are practice.** Interactive lab videos for rehearsing structures, used after class, run as many times as you need. They rehearse what you have already met, they do not teach it to you first.

What a TBL is

Team-Based Learning. You take a short readiness assessment on your own first, the iRAT, then take the same questions again with your team, the tRAT, and talk through the answers. Your team then works an application exercise on the same material. It covers that module's content, it counts toward your grade, and it rewards both preparing and learning from your teammates. You keep the same team all term.

The one habit that makes this work. Look over the concept lecture and the worksheet before class. Come in prepared and the check questions, the activities, the TBLs and the lab all click. Come in cold and none of them do.

05 The weekly rhythm

You meet twice a week. Every meeting follows the same shape. Learn the shape once and the term runs on rails.

A TYPICAL WEEK, BOTH MEETINGS

WHEN	DO THIS
Night before each class	Prepare. Work the guided worksheet with your notes packet and the reading open beside it, then watch the online concept lecture, then pre-study the lab structures for that day. Due before class.
Class meeting 1	Class day. Usually a guided lecture on the high-yield concepts with your worksheet and check-in questions. Some days are active learning. Lab on most days.
Class meeting 2	Same rhythm. Nine times across the term you meet for a TBL, and each module ends in an exam day.
End of most labs	Lab quiz. One randomly chosen person per team answers the lab challenge question on that day's material. The whole team earns the point, or does not.
After class	Spaced retrieval in the Mastery OS for the lecture material, and the Loops practice videos to rehearse the lab structures.
Between classes	Study. About two hours for every hour in class. See the workload note in Section 08.

The cycle is the curriculum. Keep the rhythm each week and the grade follows. Cram it into the day before and the cumulative nature of anatomy will surface the gap fast.

06 Course materials and technology

Required

- **Canvas**, the college learning management system. You already have access through your Solano account. Canvas is the system of record for this course.
- **A lab coat, and it has to be your own.** It stays in the lab all term, and it is not the one you share with your chemistry section. Have it by Week 2.
- **Non-latex nitrile gloves.** Split a box with your group. Have them by Week 2.
- **A device and a reliable internet connection** that will run Canvas, the online concept lectures and the Mastery OS. A laptop, tablet or phone is fine. Devices are not permitted in the lab, see Section 14.
- **A way to convert files to PDF** for anything you submit in Canvas.
- **Printed course packets.** I provide hard copies of the module notes, the pre-work and the lab structure lists. You complete the pre-work by hand.

Free course tools, set up in Week 1

- **Mastery OS**, the study app. Browser-based and free. Tracks your competencies, runs spaced recall, and shows you where you are weak.
- **Lecture videos**, the online concept lectures. This is where the content is taught, and it is the source you work the guided worksheet against.
- **Loops videos**, the practice and interactive lab videos. These are not the concept lectures. They are how you rehearse the lab material and work structures repeatedly after class.
- **Digital Human Anatomy Atlas**, the labeled structure reference.

Textbook, recommended and not required

- **OpenStax Anatomy and Physiology, 2nd edition.** Free online and free as a PDF at openstax.org. This is sufficient for the course.

- **Marieb, Brady and Mallatt, Human Anatomy, 9th edition** (ISBN 9780135240601). Used copies are widely available and this is the one my chapter references point to.
- Any recent two-semester Marieb Human Anatomy and Physiology works if you already own it.
- Mastering A and P is optional and is not required for any graded work in this course. Please do not buy it just because it is bundled.

Nothing in this course costs money beyond the lab coat and gloves. There is no required publisher platform, no access code, and no proctoring software to buy. If cost is a barrier to the lab coat or gloves, come and see me. The Basic Needs Center is in Building 1400 Room 1409, (707) 864-7261.

07 Grading and assessment

Five components. Three large ones at 30 percent each, and two small ones at 5 percent each.



GRADE WEIGHTING BY COMPONENT

COMPONENT	DETAIL	WEIGHT
Team-Based Learning	9 TBLs. iRAT taken individually, then tRAT with your team. No drops, no make-ups.	30%
Lecture exams	5 exams, one at the close of each module. Concept material. Mostly apply-and-reason, not pure recall.	30%
Lab practical exams	5 practicals, one per module. Timed station rotation on slides, models, charts and prosected material. No drops, no make-ups.	30%
Lab quizzes	End-of-lab team accountability question. No drops.	5%
Brain dumps	Blind retrieval on paper at the start of most class days. Individual work.	5%

Team-Based Learning, 30 percent

- Nine TBLs across the term, with your assigned team, on the TBL days marked in the schedule.
- iRAT first, on your own, then the same questions again as a tRAT with your team. Your individual preparation drives the score.
- Application and case work follow the tRAT. That part is not graded, and you should still be ready to think out loud.
- No make-ups and no dropped TBLs.

Lecture exams, 30 percent

Five exams, one at the close of each module, on the concept material from the online lectures and the in-class work. Mostly Depth of Knowledge levels 2 and 3, which means apply and reason rather than recite.

Lab practical exams, 30 percent

- **Half of every lab practical is cadaver-based, and there is no alternative.** 50 percent of each practical is set on human dissections and prosections, on the donors themselves. This is a program requirement, not a choice, and there is no substitute examination. The one exception is Exam 1, where that 50 percent is microscopy of tissues, identified on the microscopes. The rest is slides, models and charts. See Section 14.
- Timed station rotation. Spelling counts. Pen only, no pencil.

- **The doors lock when the practical starts.** If you are late you cannot come in, and there is no second sitting. Keep your answer sheet covered and your eyes on your own station.

Lab quizzes, 5 percent

- At the end of most labs, one randomly chosen person from each team answers the lab challenge question on that day's material. The whole team earns the point, or does not.
- This rewards everyone contributing and actually committing the material to memory. If a teammate is not participating, it is on the team to bring them along.
- If you are there, you earn whatever your team earned. If you are not, you earn a zero.

Brain dumps, 5 percent

- A brain dump opens most class days. You write down, from memory and on paper, what you took in from the previous class day's material and the pre-work you did for it. No book, no screen, no notes.
- You will not know in advance which part of the material I ask for, and that is the point. Preparing for one piece is not preparing.
- These are graded on honest effort rather than accuracy. A real attempt earns the credit even when the recall is rough. A few scattered words does not.
- There are no brain dumps on exam days or TBL days.
- They are low stakes individually and they add up. They are also the single best predictor I have of how an exam is going to go.

Exam cap. Exams include built-in bonus questions, and no exam score counts above 102 percent. That is the only bonus inside an exam. There is no other extra credit in this course besides Scholar Points in Section 09.

08 Grading scale and the workload

Fixed scale, applied to your final weighted percentage. There is no curve.

A 89.5 to 100%	B 79.5 to 89.4%	C 69.5 to 79.4%	D 59.5 to 69.4%	F 0 to 59.4%
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The workload, honestly

California community colleges follow the Carnegie standard: about two hours of independent study for every hour of lecture. Normally lab hours carry no outside-study expectation, because in a wet lab you run the experiment and you are done. Anatomy lab is not like that. There is no experiment. The work of the lab is committing things to memory, and you carry all of it into a timed practical, so here lab and lecture both earn the three-for-one weight.

You are in this room about 8 hours a week, which sets an expectation of roughly 15 to 17 hours of focused study outside class. Call it 24 hours a week on this one course. I would rather you knew that in August than discovered it in October. Load the early weeks heavily. Anatomy compounds, and so does falling behind in it.

This is a mastery-based course. Attending and turning things in does not by itself earn the grade. The study hours are what do.

09 Scholar Points, up to plus 3 percent

Scholar Points reward the study behaviours that actually make people succeed in this course. They are added to your final grade at the end of the term. They are not a way to recover missed work.

THE TWO PIECES

PIECE	WORTH	WHAT IT TAKES
Engagement	plus 2.0%	Log 36 verified hours across the term, drawn from three kinds of work: Study With Me community study sessions, tutoring (giving it counts the same as getting it), and open lab. Mix them however suits your week, inside two limits: no more than 20 of the 36 hours from any one kind, and no more than 3 hours a week of any one kind.
Performance	plus 1.0%	Average above 80 percent across all ten exams, meaning the five lecture exams and the five lab practicals together, and finish at least 25 of the 36 hours by the end of the semester. Both conditions, not one or the other.

This is meant to be reachable without money or a car. Tutoring someone else counts the same as being tutored, online the same as in person, hosting a Study With Me session the same as attending one, and open lab is free and already on your campus. The weekly caps mean a student working a job or caring for family can get there a few hours at a time.

You track your own hours. Keep them on the Scholar Points log sheet in Canvas and submit it at the end of every module, not all at once in December. Each entry needs the date, which of the three kinds it was, how long, and who can confirm it. Hours that were never logged cannot be counted later.

No other extra credit. Scholar Points and the in-exam bonus to 102 percent are the only boosts in this course. Please do not ask for more. There are no exceptions, because an exception for one student is an unfairness to everybody else.

10 Course schedule

17 weeks, five modules, five exam days, nine TBLs. Each module closes with an exam, and your lecture exam and your lab practical sit on the same day. These are the dates for your section. If a date has to move I will announce it in class and in Canvas.

MODULE MAP, EXAM DATES AND COMPETENCY LOAD · TUE / THU · MORNING

MOD	WEEKS	SCOPE AND TBLs	EXAM	COMPS
1	Wk 1 to 4	Foundations to Integumentary. Body organization, cavities and membranes, cell anatomy, histology, the integument. TBL 1 Cells, TBL 2 Histology.	Tue Sep 8	25
2	Wk 4 to 7	Skeletal System and Joints. Bone tissue and microanatomy, the axial and appendicular skeleton, articulations. TBL 3 Bone tissue, cartilage and microanatomy.	Tue Sep 29	30
3	Wk 7 to 10	Cardiovascular, Muscle and Blood. Heart and vessels, muscle structure and fascicle arrangement, blood, regional muscles and neurovasculature. TBL 4 Heart, TBL 5 Blood.	Thu Oct 22	41

MOD	WEEKS	SCOPE AND TBLS	EXAM	COMPS
4	Wk 11 to 14	Respiratory, Lymphatic, Digestive and Endocrine. Respiratory tract, lymphatic and immune structures, the alimentary canal and accessory organs, endocrine glands. TBL 6 Respiratory, TBL 7 GI.	Tue Nov 17	36
5	Wk 14 to 17	Urinary, Reproductive and the Nervous System. Kidney and urinary tract, male and female reproductive anatomy, brain, brainstem, meninges, spinal cord, PNS and ANS. TBL 8 Renal, TBL 9 Cranial nerves.	Thu Dec 10	61

Week by week

The pre-work for every class day, meaning the online concept lecture and the guided worksheet, is due the night before that day. Gold rows are exam days. Grey rows are days the campus is closed or we are not meeting.

TUE / THU · MORNING · DAY BY DAY, IN CLASS AND IN LAB

WK	DATE	IN CLASS	LAB
1	Tue Aug 18	Intro to Anatomy & team formation	Intro to Anatomy Lab, Lab Safety & Introduction to Histology
	Thu Aug 20	Guided DITKI Cell Activity (Brain dump)	Epithelial Tissues
2	Tue Aug 25	TBL 1 · Cell Anatomy	Connective Tissue I
	Thu Aug 27	Interactive Histology Lecture (Brain dump)	Connective Tissue II
3	Tue Sep 1	TBL 2 · Histology	Muscle & Nervous Tissue
	Thu Sep 3	Exam 1 Review Game	Integumentary
4	Tue Sep 8	Exam 1, lecture exam + lab practical. Doors lock at start.	
	Thu Sep 10	Exam 1 rebuttals + Guided DITKI Long Bone & Bone Microanatomy (Brain dump)	Bone Tissue, Long Bone & Microanatomy
5	Tue Sep 15	Skull Walk-Through (Brain dump)	Axial Skeleton: Skull
	Thu Sep 17	Spine Walk-Through (Brain dump)	Axial Skeleton: Vertebrae & Ribs
6	Tue Sep 22	TBL 3 · Bone Tissue, Cartilage & Microanatomy	Upper Extremity
	Thu Sep 24	Kahoot Review: Bone	Lower Extremity
7	Tue Sep 29	Exam 2, lecture exam + lab practical. Doors lock at start.	
	Thu Oct 1	Exam 2 rebuttals + Interactive Heart Lecture & Cardiac Conduction (Brain dump)	Thoracic Anatomy (Heart); Blood Vessel Histology & Anatomy
8	Tue Oct 6	DITKI Muscle Microanatomy & Sarcomere (Brain dump)	Muscle Microanatomy & Sarcomere
	Thu Oct 8	TBL 4 · Heart Anatomy	Muscles of the Face, Chest & Back
9	Tue Oct 13	Professional Development, no class	

WK	DATE	IN CLASS	LAB
	Thu Oct 15	Blood Cell Interactive Lecture (Brain dump)	Muscles & NAV of the Upper Arm; Anterior Forearm
10	Tue Oct 20	TBL 5 · Blood	Muscles & NAV of Posterior Forearm
	Thu Oct 22	Exam 3, lecture exam + lab practical. Doors lock at start.	
11	Tue Oct 27	Guided Walk-Through: Respiratory Anatomy & Histology (Brain dump)	Thoracic Anatomy (Respiratory) & Respiratory Histology
	Thu Oct 29	Endocrine Guided Walk-Through (Brain dump)	(Anterior) Thigh Muscles & NAV
12	Tue Nov 3	TBL 6 · Respiratory	(Posterior) Thigh Muscle & NAV
	Thu Nov 5	Guided DITKI GI Map Activity I (Brain dump)	Anterior/Posterior Lower Leg Muscles
13	Tue Nov 10	Guided DITKI GI Map Activity II (Brain dump)	GI Organs (Primary)
	Thu Nov 12	TBL 7 · GI System	GI Organs (Accessory)
14	Tue Nov 17	Exam 4, lecture exam + lab practical. Doors lock at start.	
	Thu Nov 19	Guided Renal Map (Brain dump)	Renal Anatomy
15	Tue Nov 24	Kahoot Review: Renal	Male & Female Reproductive Anatomy
	Thu Nov 26	Thanksgiving, campus closed	
16	Tue Dec 1	TBL 8 · Renal	CNS: Brain, Meninges & CSF
	Thu Dec 3	Clinical: Cranial Nerve Exam Stations (Brain dump)	Brain Stem (CNS) & Cranial Nerves (PNS)
17	Tue Dec 8	TBL 9 · Cranial Nerves	CNS: Spinal Cord & Spinal Nerves
	Thu Dec 10	Exam 5, lecture exam + lab practical. Doors lock at start.	

11 Attendance, participation and enrollment

Anatomy is cumulative and it moves fast. Missing class is costly, and most in-class work cannot be recovered.

The course rules

- **Week 1 is mandatory.** Miss a Week 1 session and your seat may go to a student on the waitlist. You may be dropped.
- **The 20-minute rule.** Arriving more than 20 minutes late, or leaving more than 20 minutes early, counts as an absence for that session. There is no partial credit for a partial session. Show up, and stay for the whole thing.
- **In-class work cannot be made up.** TBLs, exams, lab quizzes and brain dumps all happen in the room, so being absent earns a zero on whatever ran that day.
- I treat every absence the same way, whether you would call it excused or not. You never owe me an explanation or a doctor's note, and the academic result is the same either way. Life happens. The material still moves.
- **The doors lock when a lab practical starts.** If you are late you cannot come in, and there is no second sitting.

- Get into Canvas at least three times a week and turn on announcement notifications, because that is where a schedule change or an exam-coverage note appears first.
- You are on a team for the whole term. Come prepared, contribute, and answer team messages within 24 hours.

College attendance policy

Board Policy 5020 sits behind my rules. Regular attendance is an obligation you assume at registration, absences beyond the number of hours a class meets per week may result in being dropped, and an instructor may drop for unsatisfactory attendance up to the end of 75 percent of the term. A student dropped for attendance may petition for reinstatement. Full text in the college catalog.

Dropping the course is yours to do

If you decide to leave the course, you have to formally drop it yourself through your student portal. Do not assume I have done it for you, and do not assume it happens on its own. A course you walked away from but never dropped becomes an F you did not need to earn. The Fall 2026 deadlines are in Section 16.

12 Academic integrity and the use of AI

Academic honesty

Cheating and plagiarism are not tolerated in this course. A violation earns at least a zero on the work in question, may result in an F for the course, and is reported for disciplinary action. Complete your own work, cite what you draw on in MLA or APA format, and ask me if you are not sure where the line falls. Asking is always the cheaper option.

The college defines plagiarism as using another's work without giving proper credit, whether done accidentally or on purpose, and that includes not only words and ideas but also graphs, artwork, music, maps, statistics, diagrams, scientific data, software, films and video. Exam violations include communicating or transferring information to another student, using any materials other than those expressly allowed for the exam, and looking at another student's exam.

The college policy behind it

Academic honesty at Solano is published in the college catalog and enforced through Board Policy and Administrative Procedure 5300, Standards of Student Conduct. Under that policy an instructor who determines that a student has cheated or plagiarized has the right to give a failing grade, or the numerical equivalent, for the assignment or examination. Referral to the Vice President of Student Services may result in a student being expelled, suspended, or given a lesser sanction, following due process. A disciplinary F is permanent even if the course is later retaken.

You have rights in that process: written notice of the allegation, an appointment with the Vice President of Student Services, and a written appeal within ten days for suspension or expulsion, heard by a College Review Board with the college bearing the burden of proof. The Student Rights Handbook on the Solano website carries the full procedure.

Recording

Board Policy 5390 prohibits the unauthorized use of electronic listening or recording devices. Unauthorized preparation, giving, selling, transfer, distribution or publication for any commercial purpose of any recording of a class session is a conduct violation. See also the digital device policy in Section 14, which is stricter still in the lab.

Using AI

For studying, AI is encouraged, including the Teach It To An AI feature in the Mastery OS. Teaching a concept to something that asks follow-up questions is one of the better ways to find out whether you actually have it. For graded work, the rules are strict.

- Use generative AI only on assignments specifically marked as AI assignments. The title will include AI, or the instructions will say so.
- No AI on exams, and none on any graded part of a TBL.
- AI-detection tools may be used to screen submitted work. An AI or plagiarism rating above 25 percent on graded work earns an automatic zero.
- If you are unsure whether a tool counts as generative AI, or whether it is permitted on a given assignment, ask before you submit.

The AI Honor Contract in Canvas carries the full requirements. Sign it in Week 1, before you submit any graded work.

13 Late work and make-ups

No late work. No make-ups. All quizzes, exams, lab work and assignments are due by their scheduled dates. Late work is not accepted and there are no make-ups. Every in-class assessment happens in the room, in person, so missing one earns a zero.

The only built-in cushions are the in-exam bonus to 102 percent and Scholar Points. The key to this policy is simple: do not miss class. If something serious happens in your life, come and talk to me about your options in the course as a whole, including the withdrawal deadline in Section 16. What I cannot do is reopen an assessment for one student that everyone else sat under timed conditions.

14 The human donor program, conduct and devices

We work with cadaveric human donors under a legal agreement with the UCSF body donation program. This section is the one part of the course with no flexibility in it at all. Read it before the add deadline.

Working with human donors is required

Direct work with human donors is a required, graded part of this course, and that includes your examinations. Half of every lab practical exam is set on cadaveric dissections and prosections, so you are examined on the donors themselves, not on photographs or models standing in for them. Roughly a fifth of the course competencies are structures you have to find and name on a donor.

No alternative is possible. There is no alternative assignment, no photograph-only or model-only option, no substitute examination, and no way to be assessed around this. That is not a preference of mine. It is a program requirement, and the anatomy laboratory and its practical examinations are built on it. A student who does not work with the donors cannot sit the practical examinations, cannot complete the laboratory requirement, and cannot pass the course.

I am telling you this in the first week, plainly, because it is fair that you know it while you can still act on it. If working with human remains is something you cannot do, decide before the add deadline in Section 16 rather than in October.

If you are uneasy about it rather than unable to do it, come and talk to me. Nearly everyone is uneasy at first, and most people find that the first day is the hardest one. I will walk you in, I will tell you what you are about to see, and you can take a moment outside whenever you need one. That is normal and it costs you nothing. The Wellness Center is also there if you want to talk to someone who is not your instructor, at wellnesscenter@solano.edu.

Conduct in the presence of the donors

These people chose to give their bodies so that you could learn anatomy on something real. That is a gift you cannot thank them for and cannot repay. What you can do is behave as though the person is in the room, because in every sense that matters they are.

- Handle every donor and every prosection carefully and deliberately. Keep tissue covered and moist when you are not working with it, and leave the station as you found it.
- No joking, no nicknames, no horseplay, no careless language in the lab.
- Do not discuss the donors outside the lab, on social media, or with anyone not in this course. That includes describing a donor's condition, appearance or cause of death.
- Anyone who cannot meet these expectations will be removed from the lab, and it is handled as a conduct matter under Board Policy 5300, not as a classroom disagreement.

Devices, and why the rule is absolute

The people who donated their bodies to your education cannot consent to being photographed or recorded. We protect their privacy and their dignity, and that obligation is not ours to waive.

The rules

- No phones, smart watches, AI glasses, tablets, laptops or recording devices in the lab, ever.
- Devices silenced and fully out of sight. Not in a pocket, not in your lap, not on the table.
- No digital notes, no photographs, no video, no audio in the lab.
- Access digital materials outside the lab, during open study hours or at home.

Violations may mean immediate removal from the course and further disciplinary action under Board Policy 5300. Students under 18 must sign the policy, and a parent or guardian must also sign, before working in the lab.

Read and sign the digital device agreement in Canvas before your first lab. Students under 18 need a parent or guardian signature as well.

15 Accessibility and accommodation

Your success matters to me. This course is designed to be welcoming to and usable by everyone: English-language learners, students with disabilities, students returning to school after time away, and students new to this kind of course. If any part of the course gets in the way of your learning, tell me as soon as possible and we will build strategies together.

ACCESSIBILITY SERVICES CENTER, ASC

Office	Accessibility Services Center, Building 400, Room 407, Fairfield campus, 4000 Suisun Valley Road, Fairfield, CA 94534
Phone	(707) 864-7136
Email	asc@solano.edu
Portal	clockwork.solano.edu, use Google Chrome on a desktop or laptop
Hours	Monday to Thursday 8:30 am to 4:30 pm in person, Friday 8:30 am to 2:30 pm
Alternate media	altmedia@solano.edu, (707) 864-7000 extension 4466

The Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990 provides individuals with disabilities equal educational opportunities, programs and services. Academic accommodations and auxiliary aids are provided to the extent necessary to comply with state and federal law and regulation. Solano's disability services are governed by Board Policy and Administrative Procedure 5365 and by Board Policy 4310.

Set this up in Week 1. You are responsible for informing me of your approved accommodations during your first week and for providing the forms needed to arrange services, such as testing accommodations, through the term. Contact the ASC as early as you can, then send me your approved accommodations through the Canvas Inbox. Accommodations are not retroactive, so an exam you have already sat cannot be re-sat under accommodation.

16 Registration deadlines and important dates

These two tables are different things. The first is the college calendar and it governs your enrollment and your money. The second is our course calendar. Diary the first one today.

SOLANO COMMUNITY COLLEGE, FALL 2026 FULL-TERM DEADLINES

DATE	DEADLINE
Mon Aug 17	Instruction begins
Aug 17 to Aug 28	Late registration. An add code from the instructor is required
Fri Aug 28	Last day to drop a full-term class with a refund
Mon Sep 7	Labor Day holiday, campus closed
Mon Sep 7	Last day to add a full-term class
Mon Sep 7	Last day to drop with no academic record. Drop by this date and the course does not appear on your transcript at all
Tue Oct 13	Professional Development day, no classes
Wed Nov 11	Veterans Day holiday, campus closed
Fri Nov 20	Last day to drop with a W, without academic penalty. After this date you receive a letter grade, whatever it is
Nov 25 to Nov 29	Thanksgiving, no classes
Fri Dec 11	Last day to file the Pass / No Pass option for a full-term class
Dec 12 to Dec 18	Finals week
Fri Dec 18	Term ends

Two things about these dates. First, dropping is yours to do. Check your schedule bill in your student portal for class-specific deadlines, because short-term sections run on different dates. Second, November 20 is the one people miss. If this course is not going to work out, the difference between deciding on November 19 and deciding on November 21 is the difference between a W and an F on your transcript forever.

Your five exam dates are in the schedule in Section 10. There is no additional final examination during finals week unless I post one in Canvas. Exam 5 is your last assessment.

17 College policies, and where to find them

The policies below are set by the college, not by me, and they apply to every class you take at Solano. They are summarised here with the office that owns each one. The full text lives in the sources named in the last column, and I have collected the ones that matter most for this course in the **BIO 004 Course Policies and Articulation Reference**, posted in Canvas.

COLLEGE POLICY, THE OFFICE THAT OWNS IT, AND WHERE THE FULL TEXT LIVES

POLICY	CONTACT	FULL TEXT
Nondiscrimination and equal opportunity	Human Resources, (707) 864-7128	Board Policy 5360, 4030, 4285. College catalog.
Title IX, sexual harassment and violence	Human Resources, (707) 864-7128. Confidential support: Wellness Center, or SafeQuest Solano (866) 487-7233	Board Policy 4270. Student Rights Handbook.
Student conduct, discipline and appeals	Vice President of Student Services	Board Policy and Administrative Procedure 5300. Student Rights Handbook.
Grievances other than civil rights	Student Services	Administrative Procedure 5350.
Grading symbols, Pass / No Pass, incompletes, course repetition	Admissions and Records, (707) 864-7171	College catalog, academic regulations.
Academic renewal, probation and dismissal	Academic Counseling, (707) 864-7101	Board Policy and Administrative Procedure 5110 and 5100.
Attendance and being dropped for absences	Your instructor, then Admissions and Records	Board Policy 5020. College catalog.
Recording a class session	Your instructor	Board Policy 5390.
Disability accommodation	Accessibility Services Center, (707) 864-7136, asc@solano.edu	Board Policy and Administrative Procedure 5365 and 4310.
Transfer, articulation and degree applicability	Academic Counseling, Building 400 Room 404, (707) 864-7101	assist.org, the Solano catalog, and the Course Policies and Articulation Reference.

Free student support, all of it already paid for by your enrolment

- **Tutoring, ASTC.** Fairfield Library 114, Vacaville 138, Vallejo 124, plus Zoom and NetTutor 24 hours through Canvas. (707) 864-7000 ext 7230, astc@solano.edu.
- **Counselling.** Building 400 Room 404, (707) 864-7101.
- **Wellness Center, mental health.** wellnesscenter@solano.edu. In a crisis, call or text 988, or text COURAGE to 741741.
- **Basic Needs Center and food pantry.** Building 1400 Room 1409, (707) 864-7261. If you are hungry or unsure where you are sleeping, start here. It will not change how I grade you.
- **Library** (707) 864-4519 · **EOPS** (707) 863-7888 · **Veterans Resource Center** (707) 864-7105 · **Financial Aid** (707) 864-7103 · **Canvas support** (844) 303-0354.

Emergencies

Call 9-1-1. Campus Public Safety non-emergency (707) 580-6526. Enrol in RAVE Alert, the college emergency notification system, by texting SolanoCollegeRaveEnroll to 67283. Do this in Week 1.

This syllabus

This syllabus is the course agreement between us for Fall 2026, written to be consistent with the approved Course Outline of Record and with college policy. Where a course rule here and a college policy could be read differently, college policy governs. I may adjust dates or activities as the term goes and will announce any change in class and in Canvas. Grade weights and exam policy will not change.

18 A final word

Prepare, show up, help your team.

This course asks real work, and I will not pretend otherwise. But the design is on your side. You prepare the concepts on your own time, and then class is spent doing the things that actually build mastery: clarifying, applying, and getting your hands on the anatomy with a team beside you.

Keep the weekly rhythm, do the prepare step, lean on your team, and treat each other well. Your grade is feedback, not a verdict. Keep showing up, and keep going. I am rooting for you.

Dr. Sharilyn Rennie

Professor of Biology, Solano Community College